

7 Security

To use parental controls, go to **Dock > System Preferences > System > Parental Controls**. Choose the user you wish to impose parental controls on the menu in the left. The menu to the right now has the wide array of restrictions you can impose on the user. Some of its features include the ability to give the user a simpler version of the Finder; this is a feature meant for children. You can find this on the system sub-menu towards the right.

To impose restrictions on the web sites accessed by the user with the option to avoid adult sites by referencing a repository maintained by Apple, or to avoid all except an allowed list to be created by the administrator.

Using this menu, the administrator can also configure the parental controlled user account to enable only certain email and instant messaging clients, and also allow email and instead messaging only with a select set of addresses. The administrator can also set up the system in such a way that every time the user attempts to contact anyone outside this closed group, an email warning is sent to the administrator.

The administrator can place limits on the number of hours in a day, for both weekdays and weekends, that the user uses the computer. Configurations can also be made in such a way as to prevent usage during specific hours, once again separately for weekdays and weekends.

Lastly the administrator can log the users web activity, applications and iChat usage for period of time in order to enable monitoring

For all these features and more, go through the tabs found on top of the Parental Controls Popup menu.

Network Security in Mac OS

Though its Unix like architecture makes Mac OS less vulnerable than Windows to hacker attacks and other network threats, it nevertheless comes with a built in firewall, much like Windows. This firewall, known as IP is a FreeBSD project component and is thus open source.

To access the options and settings associated with the firewall, go to **Dock > System Preferences > Personal > Security**. Among the three tabs in the menu that appears, go to the firewall tab. Here, you can choose to have multiple levels of security, ranging from allowing all incoming connections to allowing only a user created list of applications to connect through the network.

The 'Advanced' button found at the bottom right corner gives you access to some features such as stealth mode, a mode that prevents your computer